



Trump all in on RFK Jr.'s agenda

HHS secretary reshapes health care, promotes debunked theories

BY DAN DIAMOND, EMILY DAVIES AND NATALIE ALLISON

Donald Trump has bought buildings, purchased airplanes and won the White House twice in his long career. But one of his most prized acquisitions is the 71-year-old former Democrat now serving in his Cabinet.

"I have a Kennedy," Trump bragged to donors earlier this year, a reference to his health secretary, Robert F. Kennedy Jr., according to two people familiar with the remarks who spoke on the condition of anonymity to detail private conversations.

The two men — once rivals for the presidency — have forged a unique relationship in Trump's Washington, with the White House granting Kennedy remarkable leeway to pursue his own agenda of overhauling the nation's health system.

In his first six months, Kennedy has used that power to remake agencies responsible for overseeing food, drugs and other medical products that touch millions of Americans' daily lives. He has worked to limit access to vaccines and promoted debunked health theories despite near-daily condemnation from public health leaders. And he is advancing some of his most controversial ideas, including by pushing an investigation that resurrects the discredited claim of a link between vaccines and autism — moves that will likely thrill his base, but could pose political risks for the White House.

SEE KENNEDY ON A6

Trump's budget plan has forced some Medicaid providers to reduce services and doctors to drop patients, leaving help much farther away



ARDEN S. BARNES/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Rural hospitals, and moms seeking care, bear brunt of cuts

BY YASMEEN ABUTALEB

Jacalyn Stuff holds daughter Roselynn, and her mom, Shannon Smith, holds Jacalyn's son Xavier at a St. Claire HealthCare facility in Morehead, Kentucky.

MOREHEAD, KY. — Jacalyn Stuff was nearing the end of her first trimester when doctors at UK St. Claire Regional Medical Center delivered shattering news: her twins were in danger.

Then came a second blow: Those doctors — the ones she had come to know and trust, the ones less than 10 minutes from her home — could no longer treat her.

During the following 10 weeks, Jacalyn — then 19 — had to travel repeatedly to hospitals able to provide more advanced maternity care.

Appointments at the one 70 miles away in Lexington required \$30 for a tank of gas. Appointments at the one 100 miles away in Cincinnati required gas and a hotel stay. And

they all required Jacalyn either to bring her infant son or to find a babysitter.

While Jacalyn's pregnancy was extraordinarily high-risk, more women are expected to face disruptive travel even for routine pregnancies because of Medicaid cuts in President Donald Trump's massive tax and spending plan.

Approved in July, the measure cuts Medicaid by almost \$1 trillion over the next decade, and the loss of revenue is expected to force scores of rural hospitals to curtail services or close, according to hospital groups.

The impact is likely to be particularly severe for maternity care, one of the most expensive services hospitals provide. Recovering the cost of maternity

SEE MATERNITY CARE ON A4

Plan to relocate Gazans floated

TRUMP'S VISION FOR ENCLAVE EXPLORED

Moves called 'voluntary' for postwar rebuilding

BY KAREN DEYOUNG AND CATE BROWN

A postwar plan for Gaza circulating within the Trump administration, modeled on President Donald Trump's vow to "take over" the enclave, would turn it into a trusteeship administered by the United States for at least 10 years while it is transformed into a gleaming tourism resort and high-tech manufacturing and technology hub.

The 38-page prospectus seen by The Washington Post envisions at least a temporary relocation of all of Gaza's more than 2 million population, either through what it calls "voluntary" departures to another country or into restricted, secured zones inside the enclave during reconstruction.

Those who own land would be offered a digital token by the trust in exchange for rights to redevelop their property, to be used to finance a new life elsewhere or eventually redeemed for an apartment in one of six to eight new "AI-powered, smart cities" to be built in Gaza. Each Palestinian who chooses to leave would be given a \$5,000 cash payment and subsidies to cover four years of rent elsewhere, as well as a year of food.

The plan estimates that every individual departure from Gaza

SEE GAZA ON A10

Hamas fatality: Key spokesman reported killed in Gaza strike. **A9**

China aims to unite leaders against U.S.'s global order

BY CHRISTIAN SHEPHERD

TIANJIN, CHINA — Chinese leader Xi Jinping has welcomed a large group of foreign dignitaries to China for meetings that he hopes will unite regional powers in their shared grievances with the U.S.-led global order and the policies of President Donald Trump.

President Vladimir Putin of Russia, Alexander Lukashenko of Belarus and India's Narendra Modi are among 20 foreign leaders attending the two-day Shanghai Cooperation Organization summit, which began Sunday in this port city 90 miles southeast of Beijing.

The forum is a key part of China's campaign to be seen as a reliable partner and a counterweight to U.S. unpredictability in an increasingly multipolar world. Modi's attendance in particular — his first visit to the country in seven years — is a milestone in Beijing's attempt to mend ties with an influential U.S. partner that has been alienated by Trump's tariffs.

For now, the 26-country grouping is primarily "united in a sense of aggrievement with the U.S. rather than a sense of common purpose," said Carla Freeman,

SEE SUMMIT ON A12



JOSHUA LOTT/THE WASHINGTON POST

A resistance campaign

Illinois Gov. JB Pritzker (D) and Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson are voicing their opposition to President Donald Trump's threatened National Guard deployment in the city. **Story, A6**

For the Class of 2029, finding a roommate is a post away

Instagram pages serve as platform to pair up

BY DAN ROSENZWEIG-ZIFF

Katie Lim worried selecting a bad roommate could tank her freshman year before it even began. A portal from the University of Maryland read like a government form: dense with text, full of questions to find possible pairings that were both vague yet oddly specific and utterly devoid of vibes. There wasn't a single photo.

So the 18-year-old did what any self-respecting Gen Zer would do: She turned to Instagram. There she found not one, but three different pages run by private companies to help members of the Class of 2029 find roommates. Lim picked the one with the most engagement, uploaded 10 carefully curated photos (volleyball, Chipotle, friends) and waited.

Two weeks later, her profile

was live. The payoff was almost immediate: 150 new followers to her Instagram account and 30 DMs. The roommate search was officially on.

For the next week and a half, Lim basically ran a small HR department — privately messaging candidates for hours a day, and even enlisting ChatGPT and Google's Gemini to help craft the perfect interview questions. One two-hour FaceTime later, she had her winner. After Lim and her new roommate notified U-Md. over the summer that they wanted to live together, the two moved into their College Park dorm last week.

As students across the country return to campus for the fall semester, Lim is part of a growing number of incoming first-years outsourcing their roommate

SEE ROOMMATES ON A7

Park Police resume car chases as part of federal surge in D.C.

BY EMMA UBER

U.S. Park Police have initiated at least 10 car chases in the past three weeks as part of President Donald Trump's surge in federal law enforcement in D.C., court records show. They're pursuing drivers they tried to stop for tinted windows and fake tags,

broken headlights and running a stop sign.

A driver with a minor in the back seat struck a tree, then a guardrail. Another accelerated to more than 80 mph before hitting multiple cars on Interstate 295. A third nearly hit a detective before flipping the car. Court records reviewed by The Washing-

ton Post show that among the 10 chases since Aug. 14, at least six involved crashes.

The pursuits — all of which began as traffic stops for nonviolent crimes and were initiated by federal task forces formed in response to Trump's Aug. 11 executive order — would have violated D.C. police policy. The Dis-

trict's police department allows car chases only when the driver is putting other lives in danger or is suspected of committing a violent crime.

Park Police had pursued only for people wanted for violent felonies, after two officers chased, then shot and killed

unarmed motorist Bijan Ghaisar in Northern Virginia in 2017.

But last week, Park Police said those chase restrictions were gone.

"That's right criminals," the Park Police union posted to its X account. "If you flee from a traffic stop in DC, we will chase you — and we will catch you. Tell your friends."

Police departments across the

SEE CHASES ON A2

IN THE NEWS

Veterans facing removal Some noncitizens who served in the U.S. military and went to prison are being stripped of legal residency and could be deported. **A3**

World's longest bridge In a NATO pledge to boost defense spending, Italy sees a chance to fulfill an ambitious infrastructure project. **A8**

THE NATION **The Trump** administration grounded planes carrying migrant youths it intended to deport to Guatemala after a judge temporarily blocked the children's removal from the United States. **A2**

THE WORLD **The trial of** former Brazilian president Jair Bolsonaro, which starts Tuesday, represents the first time the country has charged a leader for subverting the will of the people. **A9**

THE ECONOMY **More and more,** employers are looking for "AI fluency" in their next hires. Here's what that means. **A13**

STYLE **Julia Roberts** is charming Venice festivalgoers, even as her new film, "After the Hunt," confounds some critics. **B1**

SPORTS **The Nationals** are spiraling as they reach baseball's traditional turn for home, dropping their eighth straight. **C1**

THE REGION **The U.S. attorney's** office in D.C. is working to lessen penalties for some past offenses involving long guns. **C7**

In search of a balm for chaotic times, punk rock fans turn to mosh pits at a D.C. library. **C7**

HEALTH & SCIENCE **A painful fall** led to a series of unusual symptoms for a Wisconsin farmer. Was extra-strength acetaminophen to blame? **E1**

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The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54326

